Andragogical Inclusion: A Professional Knowledge Exchange

Bridging Lived Experience, Equity, and Academic Rigour in Adult Learning

Community of Practice

Peer Community: Convening as scholarly practitioners sharing expertise.

Critical Andragogy

Critical Synthesis: Interrogating where adult learning theory meets social justice.

Equitable Rigour

Action Horizon: Generating tangible curricular adaptations for next week.

Facilitator Provocation: Welcome. We are establishing this room as a community of practice. Everyone here brings pedagogical expertise to interrogate and share.

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Knowles' Andragogy Meets Critical Equity



Malcolm Knowles
(Classical Theory)

- Self-Directed: Adults resist imposed knowledge.
- Life Experience: Learners bring a rich reservoir of prior knowledge.
- Immediate Relevance: Content must apply to current goals.



The Equity Expansion
(Modern Reality)

- Power Dynamics: Marginalization dictates who feels safe sharing.
- Psychological Safety: Trauma and socioeconomic status condition participation.
- Proactive Design: Inclusion removes barriers before adjustments are requested.

Facilitator Provocation: Whose lived experience is most easily validated in our curriculum, and who has to work harder to be heard?

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The Inclusion Marketplace



Time Poverty & Role Conflict

- Shift work and unpredictable hours.
- Active parenting and intensive elder care.



Neurodivergence

- High executive load for organizational tasks.
- Hidden exhaustion from autistic/ADHD masking.



Linguistic Diversity

- The trap of hidden academic language codes.
- Exclusion via culturally specific examples.



Digital Divide

- Reliance on mobile-only or shared devices.
- Low bandwidth impacting synchronous learning.

Facilitator Provocation:
These are the dominant barriers in our cohorts. Think of them not as student deficits, but as design challenges for us to solve through Universal Design.



Schooling Scars

- Past educational trauma in formal schooling.
- Persistent fear of academic exposure.

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Friction vs. Flow: Marketplace Task

Friction (Exclusive)	Flow (Inclusive)
Punitive attendance rules	Robust asynchronous scaffolding
Vague, implicit assessment briefs	Transparent in Learning and Teaching (TILT)
Assuming prior academic literacy	Co-created glossaries and term banks
High-bandwidth synchronous demands	Low-bandwidth, flexible access

Task (15 Mins) - 3 mins per station:



- **Green Post-It**: Document what already works in your module.
- **Amber Post-It**: Document persistent institutional barriers we face.

Facilitator Provocation: Look at the matrix. Are we relying on reactive accommodations or proactive Universal Design? Document the reality of your modules.

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Applied Case Studies: Choose Your Lens

Pathway A



Clinical Audiology

Clinical training with mature healthcare learners

Tension point: High-stakes physical exams and sensory sensitivities

Pathway B



HyFlex Health

Allied health learners balancing shifts and childcare

Tension point: Extreme workloads and synchronous distance isolation

Pathway C



Level 5 Coaching

Mid-career professionals transitioning to leadership

Tension point: Masking literacy struggles with academic resistance

Your Task: Self-select into the scenario closest to your discipline.
Identify hidden friction and co-design a rigorous adjustment.

Facilitator Provocation: Adult learning theory is only as good as its application. We are looking for solutions that elevate rigor rather than dropping standards.

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Case Study A: Clinical Psychological Safety

The Tension

- **The Barrier:** Severe performance anxiety during peer physical exams.
- **The Cause:** Unmet sensory limits and fear of non-compliance.

The Co-Design Adjustment

- **Proactive Safety:** Co-construct physical examination safety contracts on Day 1.
- **Scaffolding:** Implement low-stakes, highly scaffolded simulated practice sessions.

Pedagogical Payoff: Deepens patient empathy and improves clinical self-regulation.

Facilitator Provocation: How often do we mistake compliance for competence? By co-designing ground rules, we hand autonomy back to the adult learner.

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Case Study B: Workload-Sustainable HyFlex

The Tension

- **The Barrier:** Distance shift-workers isolated and falling behind.
- **The Cause:** 40-page weekly PDF readings and synchronous live board demands.

The Co-Design Adjustment

- **Targeted Focus:** Micro-chunked reading briefs targeting specific clinical takeaways.
- **UDL Expression:** Multi-modal responses (voice notes, short video) and asynchronous peer pods.

Pedagogical Payoff: Creates equal engagement parity without causing staff burnout.

Facilitator Provocation: Inclusion that breaks the lecturer is not sustainable. How does micro-chunking and multi-modal feedback save us time while helping them?

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Case Study C: UDL in Leadership

The Tension ⚠

⚠ **The Barrier:** Defensive resistance to academic essays and theory.

🔍 **The Cause:** Senior apprentice masking undiagnosed dyslexia.

The Co-Design Adjustment

🎙 **Multiple Means of Action:** Introduce oral reflection vivas.

Tech Integration: Seamless assistive technology and speech-to-text tools.

Scaffolding: Provide structured, reflecti[illegible] sentence stems for written work.

Pedagogical Payoff: Evaluates true executive leadership mastery without academic literacy gating.

Facilitator Provocation: Are we testing their leadership coaching skills, or their academic essay-writing skills? UDL allows us to separate the construct from the method.

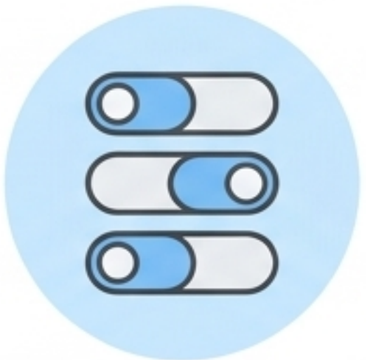
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The Next Week Redesign



Current Friction

Identify: Where does an unnecessary design roadblock occur in your module?



Pedagogical Adjustment

Modify: What low-barrier modification removes this specific friction?



Academic Rigour

Elevate: How is the core cognitive standard preserved or strengthened?

Facilitator Provocation: Select ONE activity or assessment you are teaching next week. Run it through this matrix. Inclusion isn't about doing less; it's about removing noise.

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Differentiated Pathways to Practice

Developing Practitioners

- **Focus:** Concrete, low-prep inclusive teaching strategies.
- **Action:** Embed 2–3 ready-to-use techniques into next week's plan.
- **Goal:** Build confidence in proactive universal design.

Experienced Lecturers

- **Focus:** Complex edge-cases balancing inclusion and professional standards.
- **Action:** Design a micro-evaluation to measure a novel adaptation's impact.
- **Goal:** Share evidence of curricular adaptation success.

Facilitator Provocation: Respecting the expertise in this room, choose your pathway. Focus on immediate high-impact tools, or measure the impact of an edge-case adjustment.

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Plenary: Choose Your Exit Commitment

Andragogy + Equity + Intentional Design = Autonomous Adult Learners

Option A

Quick Win

Share a 60-second summary of a barrier you are removing next week.

Option B

Critical Tension

Pose an unresolved standard vs. flexibility dilemma to the room.

Option C

Peer Pact

Pair up with a colleague to swap feedback on your redesign.

Facilitator Provocation: We end by committing to action. How will you consolidate today? Let's hear your exit commitments.

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